



Setting up Visual Studio Code

VS Code is a free code editor, which runs on the macOS, Linux, and Windows operating systems. Getting up and running with Visual Studio Code is quick and easy. It is a small download so you can install in a matter of minutes and give VS Code a try.

VS Code is lightweight and should run on most available hardware and platform versions. You can review the [System Requirements](#) to check if your computer configuration is supported.

Set up VS Code for your platform

1 Download and install Visual Studio Code for your platform

- [macOS](#)
- [Linux](#)
- [Windows](#)

Note

VS Code ships monthly releases and supports [auto-update](#) when a new release is available.

2 [Install additional components](#)

Install Git, Node.js, TypeScript, language runtimes, and more.

3 [Install VS Code extensions from the Visual Studio Marketplace](#)

Customize VS Code with themes, formatters, language extensions and debuggers for your favorite languages, and more.

4 [Enable AI features](#)

Tip

If you don't yet have a Copilot subscription, you can use Copilot for free by signing up for the [Copilot Free plan](#) and get a monthly limit of inline suggestions and chat interactions.

Update cadence

VS Code releases a new version [each month](#) with new features and important bug fixes. Most platforms support auto updating and you are prompted to install the new release when it becomes available.

You can also manually check for updates by running **Help > Check for Updates** on Linux and Windows, or running **Code > Check for Updates** on macOS.

Note

You can [disable auto-update](#) if you prefer to update VS Code on your own schedule.

Insiders nightly build

If you'd like to try our nightly builds to see new features early or verify bug fixes, you can install our [Insiders build](#). The Insiders build installs side-by-side with the monthly Stable build and you can freely work with either on the same machine. The Insiders build is the same one the VS Code development team uses on a daily basis and we really appreciate people trying out new features and providing feedback.

Portable mode

Visual Studio Code supports [Portable mode](#) installation. This mode enables all data created and maintained by VS Code to live near itself, so it can be moved around across environments, for example, on a USB drive. See the [VS Code Portable Mode](#) documentation for details.

Next steps

Once you have installed VS Code, these topics will help you learn more about it:

- [VS Code tutorial](#) - A quick hands-on tour of the key features of VS Code.
- [Tips and Tricks](#) - A collection of productivity tips for working with VS Code.
- [AI-assisted coding](#) - Learn about using GitHub Copilot in VS Code to help you write code faster.

Common questions

What are the system requirements for VS Code?

We have a list of [System Requirements](#).

How big is VS Code?

How do I create and run a new project?

VS Code doesn't include a traditional **File > New Project** dialog or pre-installed project templates. You'll need to add [additional components](#) and scaffolders depending on your development interests. With scaffolding tools like [Yeoman](#) and the multitude of modules available through the [npm](#) package manager, you're sure to find appropriate templates and tools to create your projects.

How do I know which version I'm running?

On Linux and Windows, choose **Help > About**. On macOS, use **Code > About Visual Studio Code**.

Why is VS Code saying my installation is unsupported?

VS Code has detected that some installation files have been modified, perhaps by an extension. Reinstalling VS Code will replace the affected files. See our [FAQ topic](#) for more details.

How can I do a 'clean' uninstall of VS Code?

If you want to remove all user data after [uninstalling](#) VS Code, you can delete the user data folders Code and .vscode. This returns you to the state before you installed VS Code. This can also be used to reset all settings if you don't want to uninstall VS Code.

The folder locations vary depending on your platform:

- **Windows** - Delete %APPDATA%\Code and %USERPROFILE%\ .vscode.
- **macOS** - Delete \$HOME/Library/Application Support/Code and ~/ .vscode.
- **Linux** - Delete \$HOME/ .config/Code and ~/ .vscode.

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☐ Yes ☐ No

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